

ASSAM



Bodoland

Districts: 4

Population: 30 lakh

Area: 8,795 sq km

MPs: 1

Economy: The main source of livelihood is agriculture and cattle farming. The main crops of the region include paddy. The Manas Wildlife Sanctuary has also been included in the proposed state.

ORISSA



Mahakoshal

Districts: 10

Population: 90 lakh

Area: 50,399 sq km

MPs: 6

Economy: It is a poverty ridden zone known for drought, famine and sale of children. But it is also dotted with steel plants, cement factories and coal fields.

BIHAR/UP/MP



Bhojpur Mithilanchal

Districts: Bhojpur- 12 from UP, nine from Bihar and two from MP

Mithilanchal- 10 from Bihar

Population: 12 crore in Bhojpur and 4 crore in Mithilanchal

Area: 86,346 sq km in Bhojpur and 20,572 sq km in Mithilanchal

MPs: 11 each from Bihar in Bhojpur and Mithilanchal

Economy: Both the regions are dependent on agriculture though Bhojpur does have several sugar mills. Mithilanchal is a flood-prone area and its economy is one of India's poorest.

MADHYA PRADESH



Madhya Pradesh

Gondwana

Districts: 26

Population: 2.65 crore

Area: 1.59 lakh sq km

MPs: 15

Economy: The region is heavily dependent on mining for its revenue. Major minerals found here include iron ore, limestone, bauxite, manganese and coal. The area is also famous for the diamond mines of Panna. It is also rich in forest wealth which offers scope for a number of livelihood opportunities like timber logging.

try. It is for creating a huge state of more than 50 districts where there are Gondi dialect speaking people at a time when economic indicators have to be the priority in deciding on formation of new states. Not to be left out, the Telangana conundrum has also enthused Bodos who have been demanding the creation of Bodoland.

Telangana should, ideally, result in a meaningful remapping of India. Such a complex exercise bristles with problems and Telangana shows how they could be overcome. The biggest fear is about losing Hyderabad to the new state. Without the modernising metro, the economic viability of Telangana is in question. If the vast Hyderabad Metropolitan Development Authority area, which is possibly the source for at least 30 per cent of the revenue and the spur for future growth, is left out, Telangana will remain an impoverished state for long. Now, all parties across the spectrum are sharply divided after the ham-handed manner in which the announcement was made on the green signal for the formation of Telangana while the state legislature was in session. Telangana can no longer be wished away and, if granted without Hyderabad, there may well be violent upheavals.

Many such vexatious issues will crop up in a wider remapping exercise based on the nature, content and the levels of consciousness raised by the separate statehood campaigns elsewhere. And if it is to be done on economic reasoning, given the wealth of data and indices to be interpreted, only a commission comprising specialists can deliver the outlines of more new states for quicker growth in a resurgent India. After all, if the other great democracy can afford to have 50 states and be the superpower, why can't India have a few more? Division is the road to development.

with Farzand Ahmed, Malini Bhupta, Uday Mahurkar, Abhijit Dasgupta, Amitabh Srivastava, Ambresh Mishra, Stephen David and Kaushik Deka

“For the people of Vidarbha, Mumbai is inaccessible and politicians hailing from this region are interested in serving their own interests.”

KISHORE TIWARI, Vidarbha Jan Andolan leader

